ODISSEI Annual Plan 2027

What the Dutch national infrastructure for social science will build, run and measure in 2027.



€10.24M
Planned expenditure

4
Workstreams

3
Projects: SSHOC-NL, Macroscope, PDI-SSH

45
Member organisations

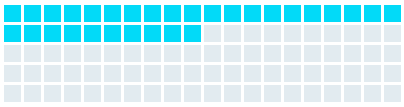
2027 at a glance

€10,235,917

Sum of the four workstream budgets

Data Facility

€3,052,182
30% of total

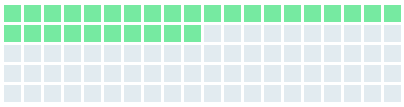


Some of the most valuable social science data are also the most sensitive. The Data Facility makes it possible for researchers to find such data, request access, and analyse it in a protected setting where the data owner stays in control.

- Access in about two weeks instead of three to four
- OSSC opened to a first provider beyond CBS
- FIRMBACKBONE from request to workspace by spring

Observatory

€3,075,626
30% of total

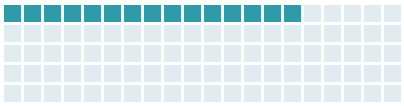


The Observatory sustains the long-running data collections the community relies on and opens up kinds of data that did not exist a few years ago.

- PANL opens its public beta
- First wave of the Web & Media Diets Observatory
- First shared question bank for international surveys

Laboratory

€1,565,604
15% of total

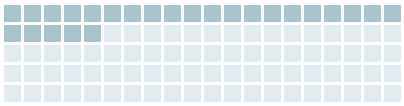


The Laboratory develops shared tools that let researchers study digital traces and social networks responsibly, so research groups can build on common tools instead of creating their own.

- D3I becomes a full service
- Online experiments open to all researchers
- New methods for safer network research

Hub

€2,542,505
25% of total



Data and tools matter only when researchers know they exist, can get help using them, and trust they are used responsibly. The Hub is where researchers find that help.

- Support measured from January
- One process for every access grant
- An Ethics Forum with a public voice

The year ahead

The commitments in this plan that come with a date. All other plans are due during 2027.

January

Every support request and use of a facility is recorded

So ODISSEI can see which members use which facilities, and how quickly researchers get an answer.

Hub

Early 2027

The online experiments workspace opens to all researchers

With a support plan. The first large experiment then runs with LISS households.

Laboratory

Spring

FIRMBACKBONE goes from approved request to secure workspace without manual steps

The first dataset on the new secure route. The KB web archive follows.

Data Facility

Spring

ODISSEI and SURF agree how international researchers can use SANE

Replacing the EOSC-ENTRUST route, which ends in 2026.

Data Facility

June

The SANE credit model is evaluated

The boards receive a recommendation on how secure computing is paid for.

Data Facility

Every quarter

A new release of SANE

Based on what researchers in current projects need.

Data Facility

Message from the Chair

Portrait

The Chair’s opening letter introduces the plan and its priorities for 2027.

The full message, about 450 to 500 words, has not been drafted yet. It will appear here with a portrait and one highlighted quote.

Why ODISSEI matters

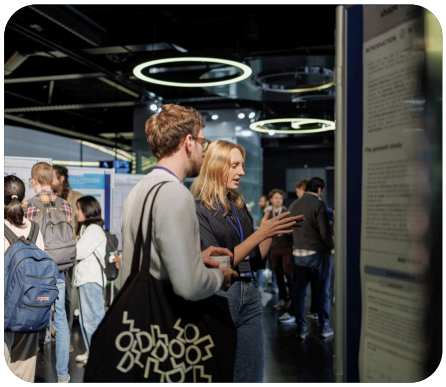
ODISSEI gives social scientists in the Netherlands shared access to data, secure computing, tools and expertise that individual institutions would otherwise have to organise for themselves. More than 45 organisations are members. In 2027, much of this work is carried out through three projects, SSHOC-NL, Macroscope and PDI-SSH, which are coordinated as joint SSH-RI task plans with CLARIAH. This plan describes the work through ODISSEI's four workstreams: the Data Facility, the Observatory, the Laboratory and the Hub.

Many research questions about Dutch society depend on data that are sensitive, collected over long periods, or gathered in new ways. Examples are questions on inequality, ageing, education, labour markets, health and digital life. Working with such data requires secure environments, legal agreements, long-term data collection and specialised methods. ODISSEI provides these as shared services, so that researchers at member organisations can use them for their own projects.











Conference photos: ODISSEI Conference 2025, nelinadasha.com. Other photos: [credit to be confirmed]

Secure access to sensitive data

CBS microdata, linked administrative records and digital trace data can only be analysed in protected environments. ODISSEI supports access to CBS microdata and offers SANE (Secure Analysis Environment) and the OSSC (ODISSEI Secure Supercomputer) for sensitive data from other providers, so that institutions do not each need to build their own. Data providers keep control over their data, and researchers follow one brokered process. The number of projects on SANE grew from 20 in mid-2025 to 67 in June 2026.

Finding and reusing data

The ODISSEI Portal, the knowledge graph and FAIR archiving at DANS help researchers find datasets, connect them, and keep results available for future research. The Portal holds metadata from 19 of ODISSEI's 27 scientific members and attracts more than 500 unique visitors a month.

Data collections that follow society over time

Questions about social mobility, ageing, inequality and family formation need data collected consistently over many years. ODISSEI supports collections that follow the same individuals, households and families over time, and collections that repeat the same questions with new samples to track trends. These include the LISS panel, which is representative of the Dutch population, and the Dutch participation in SHARE (Survey of Health, Ageing and Retirement in Europe), ESS (European Social Survey), EVS (European Values Study), WVS (World Values Survey) and GGP (Gender and Generation Programme), which allows comparison with other countries. PANL adds a flexible platform for fast participant recruitment, and historical records from the Historical Sample of the Netherlands extend the view across generations. The LISS Data Archive has more than 14,000 registered users, and 1,912 publications based on LISS data are known.

Tools for new types of data

Researchers increasingly need digital traces, behavioural data and experiments alongside surveys. Through data donation, mass online experiments and the Netherlands Media Corpus, ODISSEI offers shared tools for collecting digital trace data, running large interactive experiments and connecting survey answers with media content. These support research on topics such as social media, misinformation and online behaviour, without each project having to build its own tools.

Methods for population-scale analysis

PLANET-NL provides open-source software for analysing networks that cover the Dutch population and for assessing the risk that such data reveal individuals. This allows these methods to be used safely within secure environments.

Support, training and coordination

Infrastructure is only useful when researchers can use it with confidence. The Hub offers access grants, fellowships, consultations, ethical and legal guidance, and training such as the ODISSEI-SICSS Summer School. It also coordinates ODISSEI's work with CLARIAH, SURF, DANS, CBS and European partners.

The three projects currently run by ODISSEI have complementary roles: SSHOC-NL builds foundations, Macroscope extends what researchers can do with them, and PDI-SSH helps make the resulting services sustainable. Together they aim for better infrastructure, which supports better research and, through it, a better society.

SSHOC-NL
Builds the foundations

Macroscope
Extends what researchers can do

PDI-SSH
Makes the services sustainable

2,250,000
Minutes of LISS panel time, free for researchers

52,000
Interviews conducted by ODISSEI surveys

9,946
Datasets in the ODISSEI Portal

5,846
Portal searches in the last 12 months

1,890
Publications

1,500
Attendees at events

623
CBS microdata projects financed

108
Summer School alumni

45
Member organisations

16
Projects on the Secure Supercomputer

Voices from the community

Researchers who use ODISSEI, in their own words. Portraits and quotes will be collected at the Early Career Day on 4 November 2026.



Service used, e.g. LISS panel

“

Quote from the Early Career Day interview

”

Name
Role, organisation



Service used, e.g. SANE

“

Quote from the Early Career Day interview

”

Name
Role, organisation



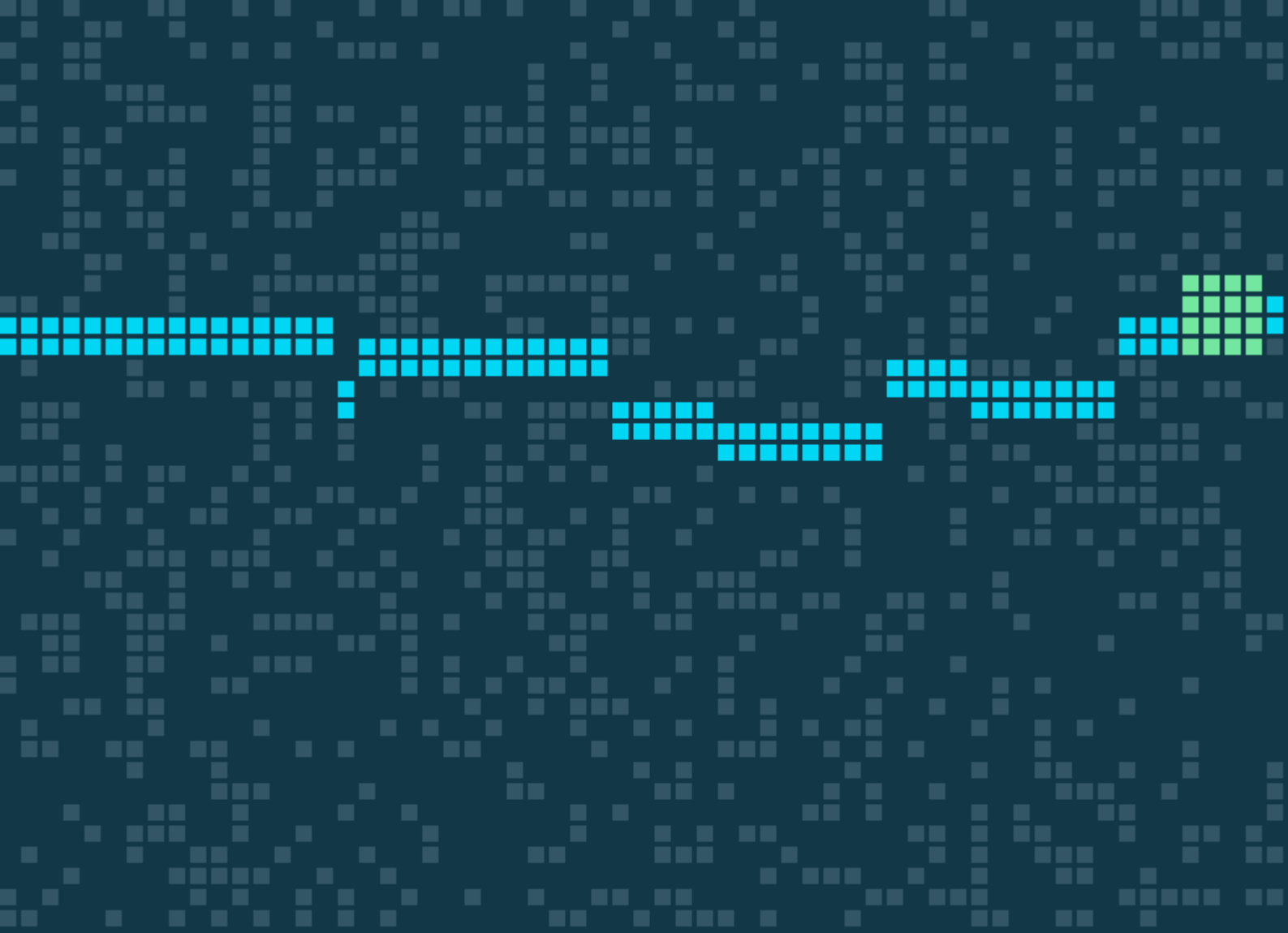
Service used, e.g. Summer School

“

Quote from the Early Career Day interview

”

Name
Role, organisation



Data Facility

From finding data to analysing it safely, in one route

Some of the most valuable social science data are also the most sensitive. The Data Facility makes it possible for researchers to find such data, request access, and analyse it in a protected setting where the data owner stays in control.

20 → 67
SANE research projects, against a target of 30

~2 weeks
Target time to access, down from three to four

€3,052,182
Budget 2027, 30% of the total

Itemised budget 2027

€3,052,182

30% of ODISSEI's 2027 expenditure

CBS microdata support	**€478,696**	Portal coverage and interoperability	**€1,083,488**	Secure computing on the OSSC	**€523,337**
SANE, incl. FIRMBACKBONE	**€966,661**				

Planned 2027 expenditure is €3,052,182. This includes €478,696 allocated to CBS for continuous support in using the CBS microdata, while efforts to ensure interoperability and expand Portal coverage are budgeted at a total of €1,083,488. A total of €523,337 is allocated to secure computing via OSSC. In addition, €966,661 will be directed to improvements in SANE, both in terms of technical development and making Firmbackbone infrastructure accessible in this environment.

About the Data Facility

Some of the most valuable social science data are also the most sensitive: tax and income records, health information, and data about people's online behaviour. The Data Facility makes it possible for researchers to find such data, request access, and analyse it in a protected setting where the data owner stays in control.

The facility has several parts that work together. CBS provides access to its rich microdata. SANE is a secure online workspace where researchers can analyse data from many different providers. The OSSC offers protected computing power for complex analyses of CBS microdata. The ODISSEI Portal and the DANS archive help researchers discover datasets and ensure results are preserved for future use. A new tool, the Data Access Broker (DAB), handles access requests digitally, much like an online application form that knows each provider's rules. A Knowledge Graph (KG) supports this by connecting datasets, variables, access conditions, code, software, and publications, making it faster to find what researchers need and easier to reproduce research. In addition, ODISSEI supports data reuse through its FAIR Expertise Hub, which advises researchers and data providers on FAIR data practices.

2026 was a year of strong growth. The number of research projects using SANE more than tripled, from 20 to 67, far above the target of 30. Logging in became much easier, and the first data provider started handling requests through the Data Access Broker. In 2027, the aim is to join these pieces into one smooth route: a researcher finds a dataset, requests it, and receives a ready-to-use secure workspace, with access granted in about two weeks instead of the current three to four. The main challenge is to keep up with demand while building these new features.

Current status

20 → 67 research projects using SANE in 2026, against a target of 30

In 2026, microdata usage remained high, and facilities for finding and requesting data were further developed. At CBS, uploading large external datasets to the OSSC became simpler, and tools are being developed to make complex data easier to use and output checking more efficient. CBS is also piloting synthetic "practice" versions of some datasets so researchers can prepare before using the real data. To support reuse and reproducibility, the FAIR Expertise Hub published a FAIR action plan, organised replication games with CBS data, and supported data providers and research projects.

The ODISSEI Portal became more stable, and a development plan was drafted. The Knowledge Graph now holds ODISSEI's standard access conditions (based on the Five Safes Framework) in machine-readable form, and the new SSH FAIR Vocabulary Registry helps researchers find shared vocabularies. The DAB is moving from proof of concept to a first stable release, with FIRMBACKBONE as the first provider to test a complete request.

SANE became a service that researchers can use without specialist help. Use grew well beyond its target, including outside the social sciences, and researchers can now access their environment in a web browser. ODISSEI brokers between researchers, data providers and SURF, and in September 2026 introduced a fixed credit budget per project to keep costs predictable.

Challenges and future needs

Demand growth and support limits

Raising awareness about ODISSEI facilities among researchers and data stewards remains a priority, but more projects, providers, and international requests will put pressure on the small teams at SURF and in the ODISSEI Coordination Team. More self-service, documentation and training are needed.

The Portal is not yet complete

Eight scientific members still have no data listed, and the software behind the Portal may develop in directions that do not suit ODISSEI.

Every data provider is different

Each has its own rules and procedures, so adding a new provider takes time, and legal agreements become more complex when several providers share one workspace.

International users need a new route

The European project that gave them access (EOSC-ENTRUST) ends in 2026.

Sensitive data need a long-term home

Existing archives do not yet accept sensitive data for long-term storage.

Dependence on partners

Some improvements, such as easier-to-use software on the OSSC and opening the OSSC to other providers, depend on technical changes at SURF. CBS's plan to issue its own persistent identifiers for datasets was delayed by limited internal capacity.

Future plans 2027

Easier-to-find and easier-to-use CBS data

CBS will issue its own persistent identifiers and publish its data catalogue, and will actively raise awareness of its facilities through events and communication with its users. It will start translating documentation into English, and introduce an application that checks research outputs faster and more transparently.

Secure computing beyond CBS

The OSSC will be upgraded and opened to a first data provider other than CBS. A prototype of a "federated" SANE, which analyses data where they are stored instead of moving them, will link SURF, the Netherlands Institute for Sound & Vision and the KB.

More and better features Each quarter

SANE will release improvements every quarter based on what researchers in current projects need, such as easier use of local AI language models, reopening closed projects to reproduce results, and better support for projects that combine data from several providers.

One secure route from search to analysis

Spring

An approved request should automatically create a secure workspace in SANE and deliver the data, without manual steps. FIRMBACKBONE, a dataset on Dutch companies, goes first (by spring), followed by the KB's web archive collection.

A sustainable service June

The credit model for using SANE will be evaluated in June 2027, and the boards will receive a recommendation. Standard agreements for data providers will make onboarding quicker, and ODISSEI and SURF will agree by spring how international researchers can use SANE.

A richer Portal and archive

The Portal will extend its coverage to member organisations whose data are not yet included, improve search results, and connect more closely to the DAB so researchers can select and request multiple datasets at once.

Knowledge Graph development

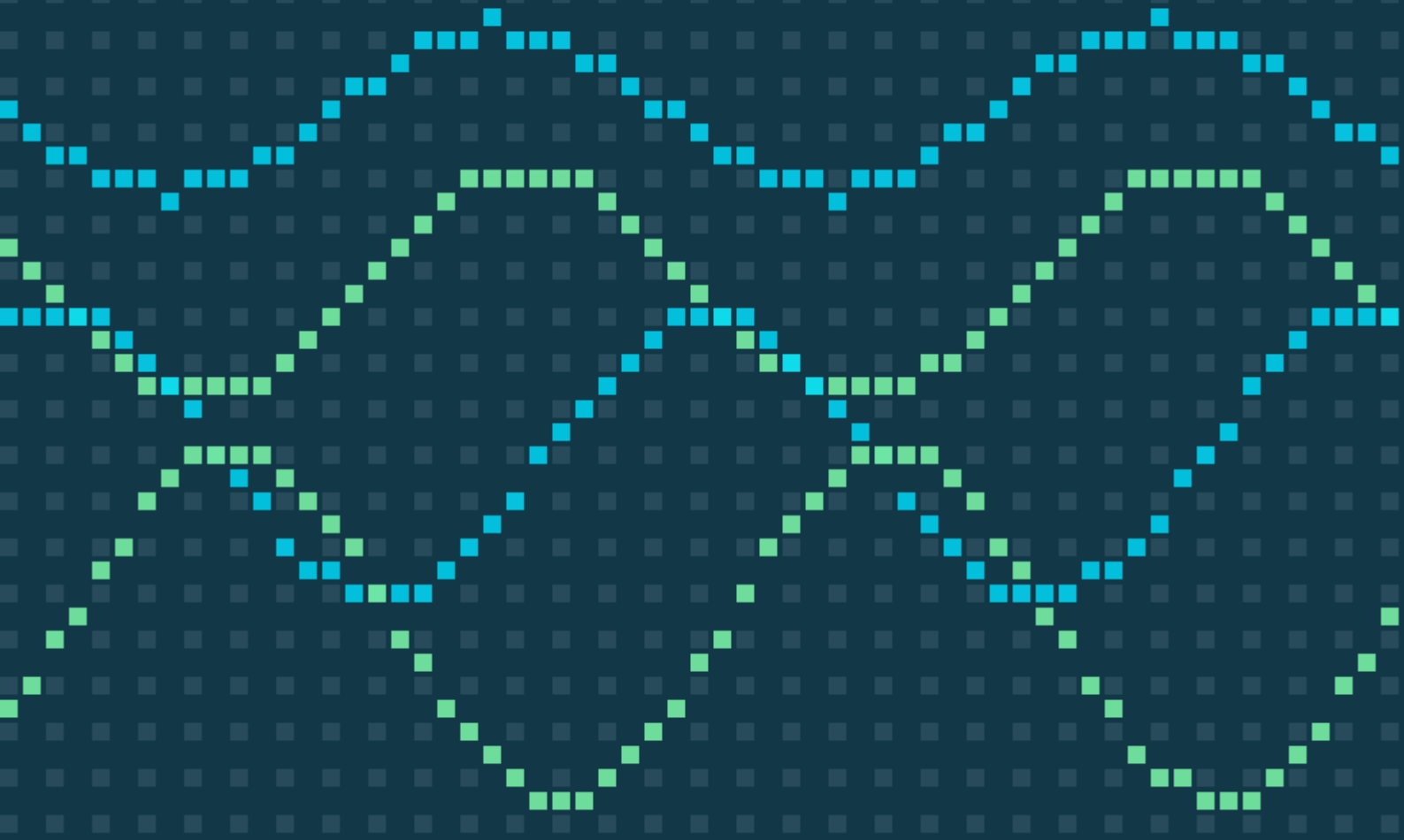
It will result in a roadmap and first prototypes. A pilot will connect the Knowledge Graph to the DAB and SANE, with records of data references, code, software, and access conditions for a study, so it can be reproduced in a secure environment in a few steps.

Consolidation in FAIR Expertise Hub

FAIR steward will help onboard more data providers to the secure data workflow of Portal, DAB and SANE, publish vocabularies that make data more FAIR, and continue its dissemination work through workshops and blogs.

European opportunities

The outcomes of two European proposals for SANE, TRELISS and FIERSE, are still pending; if funded, they would add development capacity and new users.



Observatory

Good research starts with good data

The Observatory sustains the long-running data collections the community relies on and opens up kinds of data that did not exist a few years ago.

7,500
People in 5,000 households in the LISS panel

14,000+
Registered users of the LISS Data Archive

€3,075,626
Budget 2027, 30% of the total

Itemised budget 2027

€3,075,626

30% of ODISSEI's 2027 expenditure

Data collections: international surveys	**€773,953**	Online panels: LISS and PANL incl. €216,410 PANL and €384,750 LISS interfaces	**€1,782,760**	Netherlands Media Corpus	**€518,913**







The planned 2027 expenditure for the Observatory is €3,075,626. Part of this total budget will be directed to data collections, to support international surveys and innovations, totalling €773,953. The investment in maintenance and improvements of Online Panels amounts to €1,782,760, including €216,410 for the launch and maintenance of PANL, and €384,750 for improving LISS user interfaces. The planned expenditure on the Netherlands Media Corpus is €518,913 for Web and Media diets collection and the first NMC pilots.

About the Observatory

Good research starts with good data, and ODISSEI delivers it. The workstream sustains the long-running data collections the community relies on and opens up kinds of data that did not exist a few years ago. It brings together three tasks: Data Collection, which secures Dutch participation in the major international surveys; Online Panels, home to the LISS panel and the new PANL platform; and the Netherlands Media Corpus, which turns the country's scattered media archives into a single resource for research.

For researchers at ODISSEI member organisations, this means free or low-cost access to some of the best data in Europe. The LISS panel offers a probability-based sample of around 7,500 people in 5,000 Dutch households (to be expanded in the Deepfield project), and every year the LISS ODISSEI calls fund new studies at no cost to the researcher. The SHARE, ESS, EVS and the Dutch Parliamentary Election Study provide a long view of Dutch society and place it alongside the rest of Europe. Through data donation, online experiments and mobile sensing, LISS now captures what people do as well as what they say.

Behind it all is one goal: data that can be found, linked, and analysed. Observatory data flows into the ODISSEI Portal for discovery and into SANE for secure analysis of sensitive material such as detailed geography or digital trace data. Soon, a researcher will be able to start from a survey answer, follow it to the news article a respondent read, and analyse both in one secure place.

2027 is the year these pieces start to connect. PANL opens its public beta version, giving researchers a fast, GDPR-compliant way to recruit Dutch-speaking participants and annotators, complementing the probability-based LISS panel. The Web & Media Diets Observatory fields its first full wave in LISS, recording which news and platforms people actually consume and linking that to the archived content itself at the KB National Library (KB) and other heritage institutions. And finally, the international surveys are moving toward cost-efficient, self-administered fieldwork, supported by a shared question bank, new sampling methods, and experiments to reach groups surveys usually miss.

Current status

1,912 known publications based on LISS data

In 2026, the Observatory ran at full strength while laying the foundations for the Macroscope project. The LISS panel recruited a new booster sample aimed at younger people, migrants and single-person households, moved to a mobile-first respondent portal, started building a mobile research app and added multilingual search to the LISS Data Archive. Data donation through Port is now a standard LISS feature; restricted LISS variables can be analysed in SANE. PANL completed its migration to the NEXT platform and entered a controlled soft launch.

For the international surveys, two Macroscope postdocs started at Utrecht University and Tilburg University; ESS, EVS and WVS tested self-administration in the LISS panel, and a question bank compatible with DCAT (Data Catalogue Vocabulary) and the ODISSEI Portal took shape, using LLMs to map overlap between questionnaires. The Netherlands Media Corpus team was hired at UvA and the KB, the corpus was scoped, and the Web & Media Diets Observatory was piloted in LISS together with the AlgoSoc project.

Challenges and future needs

Success brings strain

High demand for LISS panel time, plus new modules such as media-diet collection, increases respondent burden. Panel capacity and response rates need careful management.

Hard-to-reach groups

Keeping samples representative remains difficult for younger adults, migrants and single-person households, in both LISS and the international surveys.

Funding uncertainty

Long-term funding for Dutch participation in ESS, SHARE, EVS and GGP beyond 2030 is not yet secured.

Fieldwork transition

The shift from face-to-face to self-administered surveys must not break long time series.

Legal and technical hurdles

Media data come from many owners with different licences and formats, and changing EU rules on platforms and privacy affect data donation and sensitive data.

PANL must prove itself

After a slower-than-planned restart, PANL needs to attract researchers and participants at scale.

Future plans 2027

International studies continue

ODISSEI keeps the Netherlands in SHARE, funds national ESS coordination, and prepares for the Dutch Parliamentary Election Study at the next election.

Smarter, cheaper surveys

The first version of the shared question bank will be delivered, built from ESS, EVS, and other international questionnaires.

A strong, representative panel

LISS will continue to care for its panel and test new ways to recruit hard-to-reach groups. The annual LISS Core Study and the ODISSEI LISS panel call for research proposals will continue, and survey and media metadata will be registered in the ODISSEI Portal.

Reaching under-represented groups

Experiments to better reach under-represented groups are planned for the Dutch Parliamentary Election Study or SHARE, and for the ESS in 2028. Work on faster access to population samples will start.

Making study design easier

LISS panel will start developing a simple interface that helps researchers set up surveys and experiments and balance cost and quality.

Secure and FAIR by default

More sensitive LISS panel data, including GPS, accelerometer and digital-trace data, will become available through SANE.

Fast, flexible recruitment with PANL

PANL opens its public beta version to the wider ODISSEI community, and ODISSEI will run dedicated PANL calls to support usage. New features include booking and scheduling for offline studies and an environment for longer-term work with groups of annotators.

Linking people to the media they consume

The first wave of the Web & Media Diets Observatory will go live, covering at least two platforms. A new tool will let researchers retrieve archived web pages from the KB web collection by URL, and a proof-of-concept pipeline will ingest the news websites that respondents actually visited.

Frameworks for media usage research

A refined metadata model, a position paper on the Netherlands Media Corpus and a plan for audiovisual collections will be delivered. Pilot research projects will test two routes: from individuals to the content they saw, and from content in one archive to related content in others.



Laboratory

New tools for studying life in a digital, connected society

The Laboratory develops shared tools that let researchers study digital traces and social networks responsibly, so research groups can build on common tools instead of creating their own.

10
Data donation studies a year, the 2027 target

~160
Reuses a year of PLANET-NL's open-source software

€1,565,604
Budget 2027, 15% of the total

Itemised budget 2027

€1,565,604

15% of ODISSEI's 2027 expenditure

The line items add up to €1,565,605; the plan states €1,565,604. To be checked.

Data donation (D3I)	**€768,697**	Mass online experiments	**€176,146**	Large network tools (PLANET-NL)	**€620,762**

Planned 2027 expenditure is €1,565,604. Of this total budget, €768,697 will be allocated to upgrading the Data Donation facilities, ensuring the delivery of the D3I platform as a full service. Investments in mass online experiments will amount to €176,146, ensuring that the online experiments platform will be operational and ready for use. Finally, a budget of €620,762 will be allocated to securely leverage large network tools.

About the Laboratory

Much of everyday life now leaves digital traces, from the videos people watch to the messages they send. At the same time, researchers want to understand how people interact and how the networks of family, work, school and neighbourhood ties shape opportunities. The Laboratory develops shared tools that let researchers study these questions responsibly, so that research groups can build on common tools instead of creating their own for each project.

The Laboratory works on three areas. Data donation lets people voluntarily share the data that platforms such as Google, Instagram or TikTok hold about them, with full control over what they share. Mass online experiments allow thousands of people to take part in the same live, interactive study, for example, a group decision or a game of cooperation. Large network tools, developed by PLANET-NL (formerly POPNET), help researchers analyse networks that connect the entire Dutch population, using CBS data, while protecting people's privacy.

In 2026, researchers in the Netherlands gained free access to the data donation software, and data donation studies can now be set up without writing code. The first large online experiment was completed, and PLANET-NL released software that checks whether network data could reveal someone's identity. In 2027, the focus is on renewing, connecting and opening up these tools: a major upgrade of the data donation software, links between data donation, PANL and a new research app, the first large experiment with LISS households, and new methods for safely analysing population-wide networks. The main risks come from outside: new European rules could limit data donation, and skilled developers are hard to find.

Current status

4 of 6 recent data donation studies used D3I's standard templates

The Laboratory's tools are moving from research projects to services that researchers can rely on. The D3I data donation project set up a licensing arrangement that lets researchers in the Netherlands use its software for free, is signing agreements with universities, and is building a dedicated support team. Researchers can now prepare data donation studies entirely through easy-to-use screens, and four of six recent studies used D3I's standard templates. Plans for a new research app were agreed with Centerdata and Utrecht University, and a product owner and community manager started in October 2026.

For online experiments, the first use case was completed, a second one on group deliberation was designed, and a secure online workspace for running experiments was built at SURF, with a first pilot in the LISS panel planned for late 2026.

PLANET-NL maintains free, open-source software for network analysis, which is reused around 160 times a year, and has released tools to check and reduce the risk that network data reveal individuals. It launched a City Network Science Lab with the municipality of Amsterdam, and two other national statistics offices are involved in creating population-wide network data.

Challenges and future needs

The data donation software needs renewal

After five years, it must be upgraded to handle larger files, new file types and new research needs.

Changing European rules

The proposed changes to the GDPR could limit data donation, and new routes to platform data under the Digital Services Act may change how much researchers need donation.

Experiments require technical skills

Many researchers do not have the programming skills to build large interactive experiments, so they need support and ready-made building blocks.

Dependence on other launches

A first experiment on PANL can only start once PANL opens to the wider research community.

Network data are very sensitive

Privacy protection for network data is less developed than for other data types, and all tools must run in secure environments.

Finding skilled staff

Recruiting developers and research engineers is difficult and partly depends on co-funding, which may mean reducing the scope of some work.

Future plans 2027

Data donation as a full service

D3I is expected to be fully operational as a service and to reach agreements with more universities.

A major upgrade for data donation

New features will let participants share data more easily, keep some processing on their own device, donate photos and videos, and download a personal report about their own data.

Connected tools

Data donation, PANL and the new research app will be linked so participants can move smoothly between them.

A research app in practice

Two new data collection modules will be developed and tested with Centerdata, and the app will be promoted to researchers.

Better visibility

Data collection tools will be listed in the ODISSEI Portal and European catalogues, and an outreach campaign will include visits to institutions. Target: 10 data donation studies a year using ODISSEI's licences.

Online experiments open to all researchers

Early 2027

The online experiment workspace will become widely available early in 2027, with a support plan. A first large experiment will run with LISS households, a pilot will follow on PANL once it opens, and a call for experiments in the LISS panel will be published.

Ready-made building blocks

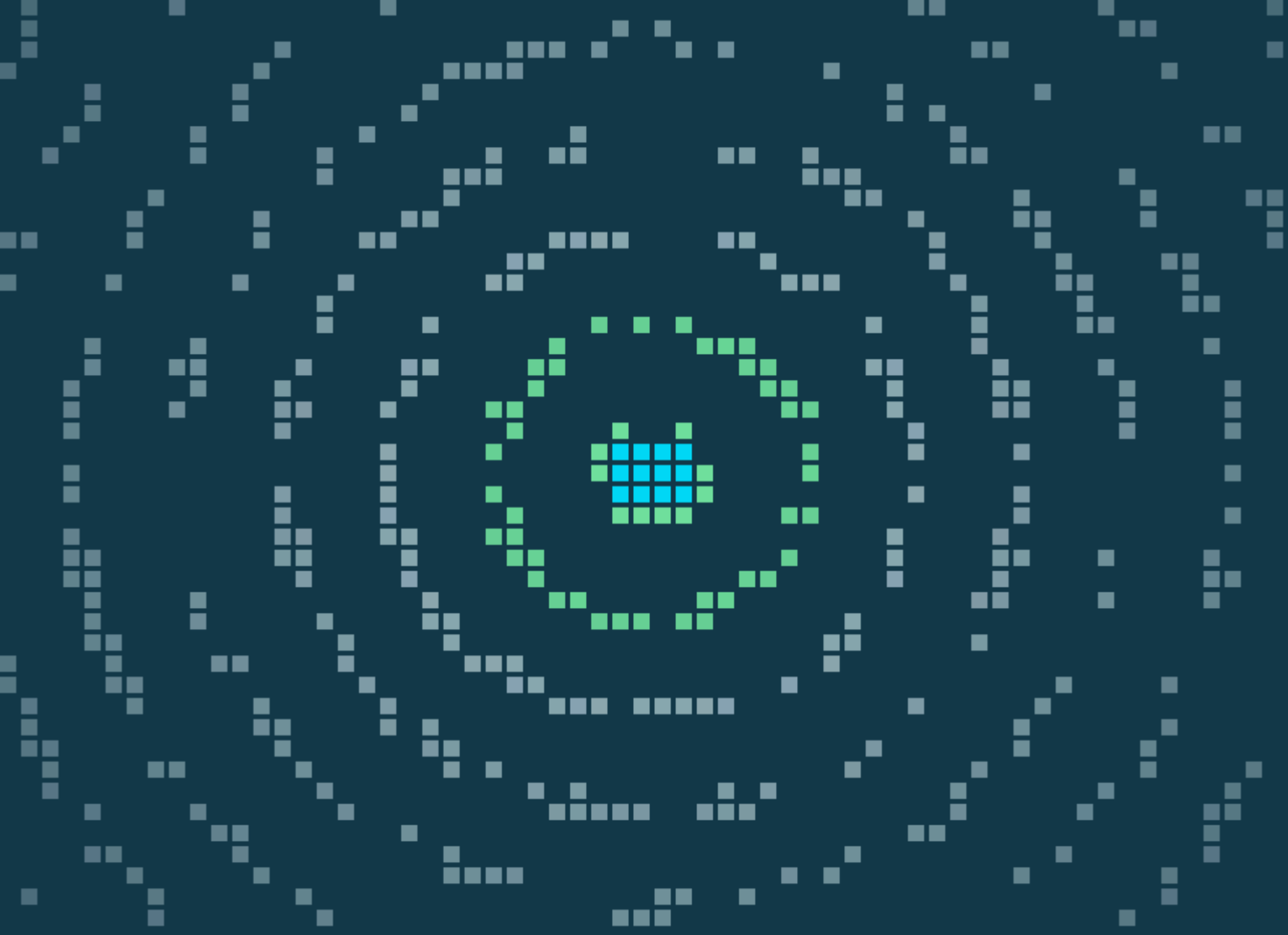
A first library of reusable experiment components will be released, and the team will explore AI assistants that help researchers build experiments.

Safer network research

PLANET-NL will develop methods that protect network data as well as ordinary tables, a visual tool for exploring networks on a map, and faster ways to find communities within very large networks.

From research to policy

The City Network Science Lab will grow into a broader policy lab, and community events will bring together researchers, policymakers and statistics offices.



Hub

The people behind the infrastructure

Data and tools matter only when researchers know they exist, can get help using them, and trust they are used responsibly. The Hub is where researchers find that help.

73
Grant applications in 2026: 27 microdata, 46 LISS

2 → 3
Social Data Science fellowships a year

€2,542,505
Budget 2027, 25% of the total

Itemised budget 2027

€2,542,505

25% of ODISSEI's 2027 expenditure

The line items add up to €2,542,506; the plan states €2,542,505. To be checked.

Coordination and shared reporting	**€848,569**	Education and training	**€469,769**	Support: front desk, SoDa, ethics	**€1,224,168**



Planned 2027 expenditure is €2,542,505. Of these resources, €848,569 will support cross-infrastructure Coordination and shared reporting activities. €469,769 is directed towards educational activities, such as development and delivery of the training programmes or ODISSEI Summer School. Finally, €1,224,168 will finance a wide array of support activities, ranging from front desk support and SoDa team methodological support to ethical support.

About the Hub

Data and tools matter only when researchers know they exist, can get help using them, and trust they are used responsibly. The Hub is where researchers find that help. It answers questions, awards grants that provide access to data and computing, trains new users, offers guidance on ethical and legal questions, and coordinates ODISSEI-run projects.

The Hub has three parts. Support includes the ODISSEI front desk, access grants, fellowships and advice from the Social Data Science (SoDa) team, the FAIR Expertise Hub, which helps researchers make their data findable and reusable, and an ethics help desk. Education delivers summer schools, workshops, tutorials and training in computational social science. Coordination covers project management, governance, reporting, communication and events for the SSHOC-NL, Macroscope and PDI-SSH projects.

In 2026, the Hub formalised its work: support procedures were documented, a new system for tracking requests and usage (CRM) went live, and the ethics help desk was extended. Grant calls were popular, with 27 applications for microdata access and 46 for the LISS panel. In 2027, the Hub will measure its support for the first time, introduce one simple process for all access grants, set up an Ethics Forum that includes members of the public, and pilot a new skills curriculum that combines online self-study and in-person training. The main challenge is capacity: as the infrastructure grows, so does the scale of operations and support delivered.

Current status

20 early career researchers trained at the ODISSEI-SICSS Summer School

The Hub became more professional and better organised in 2026. Support procedures for SANE and the grant calls were documented, more than one person now has access to every help desk mailbox, and a new system for logging requests and usage (CRM) went live in August. ODISSEI now has more than 45 member organisations, including LUMC and the Netherlands Court of Audit, which joined in 2026. The grants continue to attract many submissions.

The SoDa team continued its fellowships and around 15 consultations a year, and contributed to projects such as NL-LENS, which models life courses using administrative data. The FAIR Expertise Hub published an action plan for better data practices and ODISSEI co-organised the CBS Replication Games, where 18 researchers investigated whether six published studies could be reproduced.

The ODISSEI-SICSS Summer School trained 20 early career researchers; ODISSEI held its first Early Career Day and a conference marking ten years of ODISSEI, and it organised its first Research Infrastructure Day with CLARIAH. On the coordination side, the 13 joint tasks were set up across the three projects run by the infrastructure, the Macroscope consortium agreement was signed, the task planning process was simplified, and the SSHOC-NL progress report for 2025 was approved by NWO.

Challenges and future needs

More questions, limited capacity

As more researchers use SANE, the grants and the Portal, support requests increase, while the team remains small.

Little insight into use so far

Support has not been measured systematically, so it has been hard to see which members use which services.

The ethics help desk is underused

Its online self-assessment tool is visited, but no one has requested a consultation yet.

Missing guidance

There are no written policies yet on some recurring questions, such as requests for data from people outside academia, for example, journalists, or the use of AI language models with sensitive data. A data protection impact assessment promised at the start of Macroscope still has to be carried out.

Training needs more hours

Staff time for the SSHOC-NL training work does not match the work needed, and interest in the new curriculum still has to be tested.

Keeping a large partnership on track

In 2026, 77% of first task plan versions arrived on time, and reaching a quorum at Project Board meetings was difficult because decisions require unanimity.

Future plans 2027

Measuring support January

From January 2027, all support requests and usage activity will be recorded, so ODISSEI can monitor which facilities each member uses and how quickly researchers get an answer. Users will receive a short satisfaction survey when their grant, fellowship or SANE project ends.

Clearer information Twice a year

A guide for data stewards at member organisations will be published, with an online introduction twice a year, and a web page will clearly explain who can use SANE, the Portal, and the grants.

One simple process for all access grants

Applying for microdata access, LISS panel time, secure computing or expert support will follow one standard procedure, with short applications. Calls will be designed to reach early career researchers and disciplines that are not yet using the infrastructure much.

More expert help

The SoDa team will increase its fellowships from two to three a year and expand its consultations. The FAIR Expertise Hub will be strengthened with a dedicated position at the VU and will help more data providers join the secure data route.

An Ethics Forum with a public voice

A new Ethics Forum will include public representatives recruited through an open call. The ethics help desk will become easier to find and will be built into grant and SANE applications.

Practical guidance on hard questions

Written guidance will cover access by users outside academia, the use of AI with sensitive data, consent for data donation, standard agreements for data providers, and how to link survey participants to CBS and historical records. The data protection impact assessment for Macroscope will be completed.

Learning by doing

The ODISSEI Summer School will continue, along with workshops on topics such as AI in social science research and a second Research Infrastructure Day. The SoDa team will pilot two modules of a new skills curriculum.

Stronger user voice

The Early Career Board will continue advocating for early career researchers in the community. The Research Infrastructure Day will become a standalone annual event that brings together infrastructure providers and educators.

Smooth coordination and outreach

The Hub will continue to support the governance bodies, reporting to NWO and compliance across partners, with all task plans delivered on time. Communication and outreach activities will remain a core instrument in reaching the community.

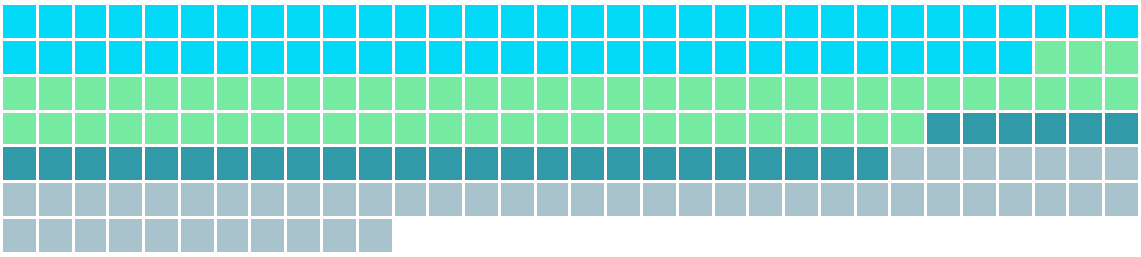
Financial plan 2027

Table 1 shows ODISSEI's planned expenditure for 2027. Because ODISSEI is one infrastructure rather than a collection of separate projects, the table is organised around ODISSEI's core tasks, which also structure the programme of work in this plan. For each task, the table shows the planned expenditure and the project or source that finances it.

All of the funding projects have been awarded and are currently under way. Membership fees are also used as co-financing for grant applications, which increases the funding available to the community.

The ODISSEI Coordination Team works closely with service providers to keep projects coordinated, avoid duplication and achieve efficiencies in implementation. The ODISSEI Management Board reviews the tasks in each project annually and adjusts their budgets to improve development and deliverables for the ODISSEI community.

Most tasks in SSHOC-NL and Macroscope are carried out jointly with CLARIAH, but a few concentrate on key investments in one community. The tasks marked "CLARIAH" are led by CLARIAH, and ODISSEI's involvement in them is limited: tasks 2.3 and 3.2 in SSHOC-NL, and task 3.1 in Macroscope.



One square is about €50,000, rounded per task.

Data Facility	€3,052,182 (30%)
CBS microdata support	€478,696
Portal coverage and interoperability	€1,083,488
Secure computing on the OSSC	€523,337
SANE, incl. FIRMBACKBONE	€966,661

Observatory	€3,075,626	30%
Data collections: international surveys	€773,953	
Online panels: LISS and PANL	€1,782,760	
Netherlands Media Corpus	€518,913	
Laboratory	€1,565,604	15%
Data donation (D3I)	€768,697	
Mass online experiments	€176,146	
Large network tools (PLANET-NL)	€620,762	
Hub	€2,542,505	25%
Coordination and shared reporting	€848,569	
Education and training	€469,769	
Support: front desk, SoDa, ethics	€1,224,168	
Total	€10,235,917	To confirm against Table 1

In 2027, ODISSEI's work is funded from several sources

- The ODISSEI core budget, including membership fees
- The PDI-SSH projects D3I, PANL, POPNET, SANE, FBB, FIP and EUR Coordination
- The LSRI upgrade Deepfield
- The SSHOC-NL and Macroscope projects
- MUW and CD2
- The EU projects AI4Social and CDIF4EOSC

Table 1, with each task, its planned expenditure and its funding source, will be added here.

Key performance indicators

ODISSEI's scope has changed over the past year. The award of Macroscope and Deepfield, together with ODISSEI's growing role in EU proposals, means the infrastructure now covers a larger and more varied portfolio than our current KPI table was designed for. Rather than adding rows to that table, we propose to monitor ODISSEI through eight questions, each answered by one indicator with its current status and a 2027 target.

Highlighted values are still being set.

1 Are members getting value?

Grant funding brought in per euro of membership fees

Now

€ X brings in € Y

2027 target

At least 1:3

Membership fees are used as co-financing for grant applications, so each member's contribution brings in more research funding than it could alone. Currently, € X in fees brings in € Y in grants, a ratio of 1:Y. Our target is at least 1:3 by 2027.

2 Is ODISSEI being used?

Active projects, and members with at least one

Now

X projects; 38% of members

2027 target

+25% projects; 50% of members

An active project is one funded through MAG calls, LISS calls or SoDa fellowships, running in SANE, or using PORT, with PANL in the future. Currently there are X active projects, and 38% of member organisations have at least one. Our target is 25 % more projects and at least 50 % of members active by 2027.

3 Is data access getting easier?

Median days from approved request to a working SANE environment

Now

Baseline from 2026 SANE records

2027 target

30% faster

We measure the median number of days in SANE from an approved request to a working environment. Currently there is no baseline; it will be set from SANE records in 2026. Our target is a 30 % reduction by 2027.

4 Is the impact growing?

Publications, citations, and policy impact of supported projects

Now

15 publications, 131 citations (Jan to Oct 2025)

2027 target

+20% in each area

We track the impact of the projects we support in science and policy, and we plan to add media impact in the future. Currently, supported projects have produced 15 publications and 131 citations (January to October 2025), and policy and media baselines will be set in 2027. Our target is 20 % growth in each area by 2027.

5 Is ODISSEI sustainable?

Structural funding share and members committed beyond 2027

Now

20.8% structural; 31 of 45 members

2027 target

30% ; 40 of 45

Sustainability rests on structural funding, reserves within the 5% rule, and members committing beyond the current period. Currently, structural funding is 20.8% of the budget and 31 of 45 members have committed beyond 2027. Our target is at least 30 % structural funding and 40 of 45 members committed by 2027.

6 Is there strategic alignment?

CBS, SURF and the SSH-Raad with a signed agreement or joint roadmap

Now

X of 3

2027 target

All 3

CBS, SURF and the SSH-Raad shape our data, computing and policy environment, and their governance should support ODISSEI's work. Currently, X of 3 have a signed agreement or joint roadmap. Our target is all 3 by 2027.

7 Are users engaged?

Researchers returning within 24 months, and yearly participation

Now	2027 target
X % return; Y participants	**40% return; +15%**

We measure engagement in two ways: the share of researchers who return to our services within 24 months, and annual participation in ODISSEI activities, such as the conference, summer school, workshops and SoDa consultations. Currently, X % of users return and Y people take part in these activities each year. Our target is at least 40 % retention and 15 % more participants by 2027.

8 Is ODISSEI positioned internationally?

EU proposals joined each year and their success rate

Now	2027 target
X a year, Y % success	**3 a year, 25% +**

EU projects such as CDIF4EOSC, AI4Social and IPDLN bring funding and influence in European research infrastructure. Currently, ODISSEI joins X proposals a year with a Y % success rate, securing € Z . Our target is at least 3 proposals a year, each linked to our mission and strategic goals, with a success rate of 25 % or higher.

Risk register

The ODISSEI Risk register is designed to support the strategic planning and decision making of the Coordination Team, the Management Board, and the Supervisory Board. Risk assessments are always subjective but consolidating the risk assessments into a singular document can help identify common risks, differences in risk perceptions across the project and interdependent mitigation strategies. The full risk register has been used to create an overview of the various challenges faced by ODISSEI.

The high probability, high impact risks for this year were identified by Task Leaders, the Coordination Team and the Management Board and listed in Table `X`. All the risks have been explicitly discussed by the Management Board and are being actively monitored by task leaders and Coordination Team contacts.

Delayed legal documents for the OSSC

A core risk is in the OSSC, where the signing of several updated legal documents is substantially delayed. This resulted in having to postpone several OSSC projects. This issue was escalated at both CBS and SURF, now ensuring the involvement and availability of the organisations' highest legal councils. It is expected that the issue will be resolved in the coming months.

Alignment across OSSC, Portal and SANE

A second core risk is the alignment between the OSSC, Portal, SANE, and the wider ODISSEI ecosystem. Entering the last project phase, the increased need for alignment of the user processes has become clear. In addition, the importance and size of the OSSC justifies an end-of-project revaluation of its user needs. To mitigate these risks, a SURF-ODISSEI sustainability strategy and an OSSC User evaluation will be developed by a joint working group between SURF and the ODISSEI Coordination Team. To oversee these developments, a new technical project manager overseeing all ODISSEI projects will be appointed at SURF, complementing the SURF-ODISSEI Research Partnership Lead.

Governance

ODISSEI is the Dutch National Infrastructure for Social Science and provides access to a federated set of services to ODISSEI member organisations. Its mission is to enable researchers to leverage comprehensive data, computing power and expertise for studies that shape policy and society.

Through ODISSEI, researchers have access to large-scale, longitudinal data collections as well as innovative and diverse new forms of data. These can be linked to administrative data at Statistics Netherlands (CBS). Combining data from a wide range of sources enables researchers to answer new, exciting, interdisciplinary research questions and to investigate existing questions in novel ways. ODISSEI now consists of 45 member organisations.

Supervisory Board

The Supervisory Board consists of seven members. Claes de Vreese (DSW, Chair), Viola Angelini (DEB), Hanneke Imbens (Statistics Netherlands), Helga de Valk (KNAW/NWO institutes and E-infrastructures), Susan Branje (DSW), Maarten van Ham (DSW), Paulette Flore (Public research institutes).

Management Board

The Management Board consists of eleven members and meets monthly to discuss and evaluate the programme of work. Daniel Oberski (UU, Chair), Tom Emery (EUR, Executive Director), Jessica Piotrowski (UvA), Marcel Das (Centerdata), Ran van den Boom (Statistics Netherlands), Annette Langedijk (SURF), Carlos Martinez Ortiz (NLeSC), Patris van Boxel (DANS), Jacco van Ossenbruggen (VU), Gert Stulp (RUG), Ioulia Ossokina (TU/e).

Coordination Team

The Coordination Team runs ODISSEI day to day. Tom Emery (Director), Kasia Karpinska (Scientific Manager), Theodora Canciu (Project Manager), Ellen Schlebusch (Tech Lead), Evgeniia Krichever (Communications Manager), Angelica Maineri (Data Manager), Tadas Bernotas (Junior Data Manager).

International Advisory Board

An International Advisory Board has been established. Julia Lane (New York University), Melinda Mills (University of Oxford), Sally Wyatt (Maastricht University), Amy O'Hara (Georgetown University).

Better infrastructure.
Better research.
Better society.

ODISSEI

ODISSEI Annual Plan 2027, prototype built from the draft of 3 November 2026. Figures are taken from the draft. Photographs are placeholders from the Annual Report 2025.